

From Capture to Care: Initiating Responsible Web Archiving at NIOD

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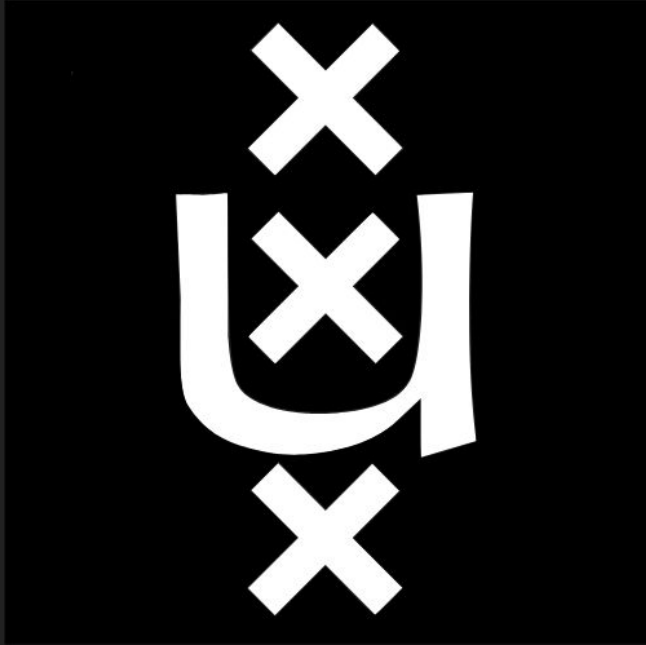
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Introduction



Archival and
Information Studies

Why archive the web during current conflicts?

Ephemerality

Online material can change or disappear.

Abundance

The scale of online material makes total capture impossible.

Responsibility

Decisions about collection and access matter

Web archiving is not only a technical problem

The NIOD Case

NIOD Institute for War, Holocaust, and Genocide Studies

- Case study project
- NIOD research and archive
- Web archiving initiative
- Broad assignment
- Limited time



NIOD Institute for War, Holocaust, and Genocide Studies (<https://www.niod.nl/>).

From institutional question to research

How can NIOD approach the first steps toward web archiving current conflicts?

Literature

- Web archiving research

Interviews

- NIOD staff

Mapping

- Stakeholders & tensions

Testing

- Making the Archive

Web archiving as institutional decision-making

Technical



What can we capture?

Institutional



What should we do?



selection · documentation · access



Competing priorities

Four recurring tensions

Abundance — Selection

What could be collected?

What should we retain?

Visibility — Vulnerability

Making material visible

Risk of exposure

Speed — Care

Acting before loss

Time for assessment

Privacy — Transparency

Protecting people/data

Making choices

How should material be captured?

MORE AUTOMATED

Greater scale

Seeds, depth,
frequency, timing

MORE MANUAL

More deliberate assessment

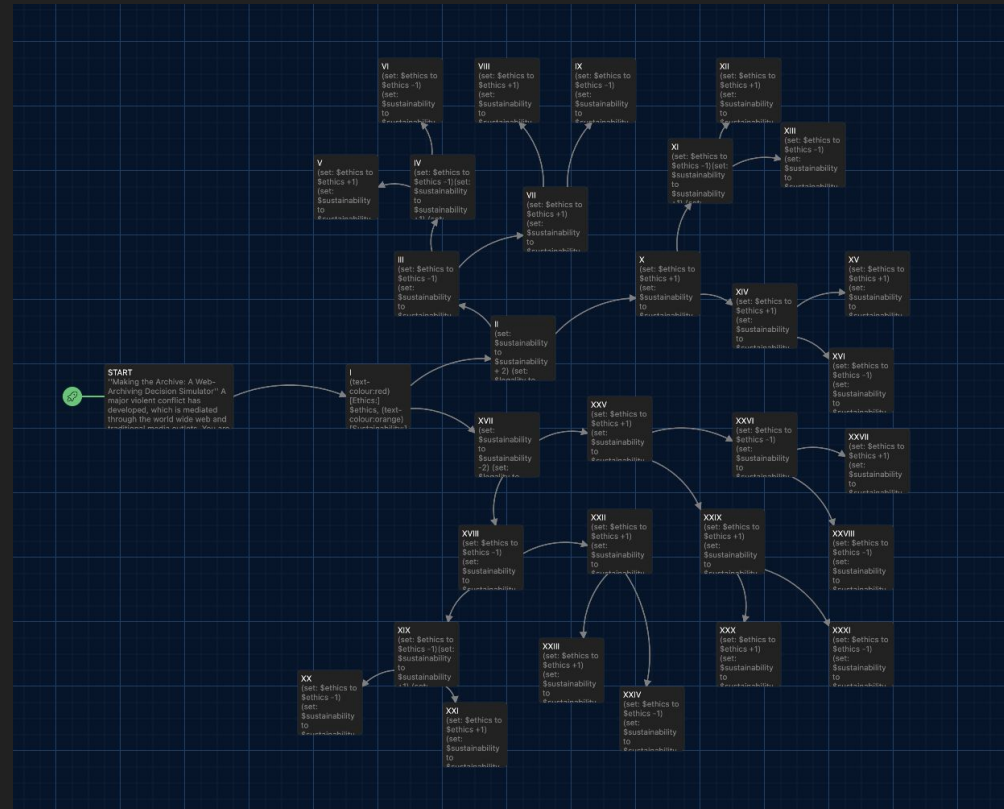
More time and resources

Neither approach removes selection.

Both embed decisions about what enters the archive.

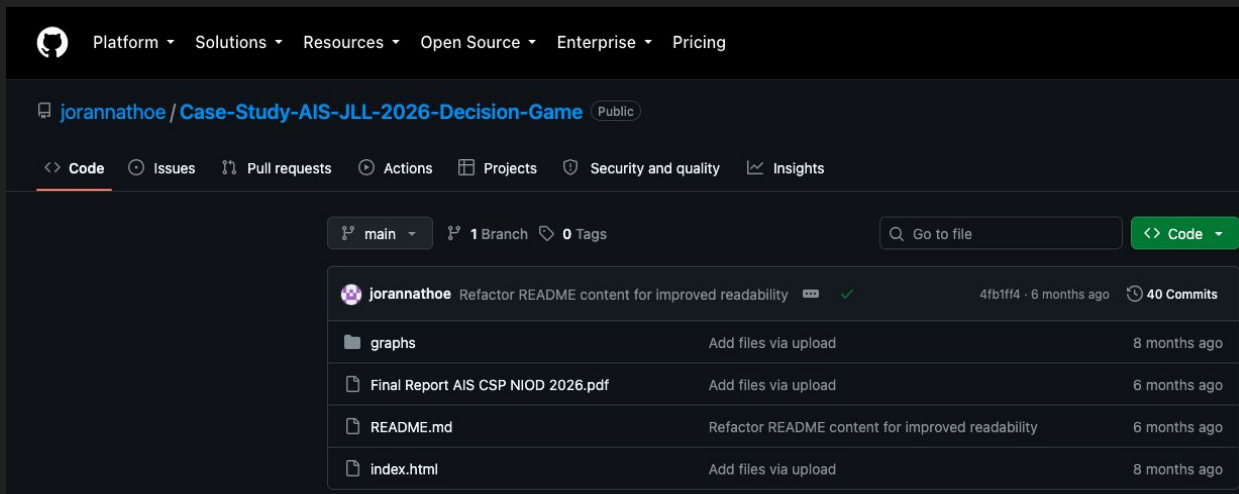
From tensions → Making the Archive

- No consensus
- Contextual
- Decision tree
- Twine



Making the Archive

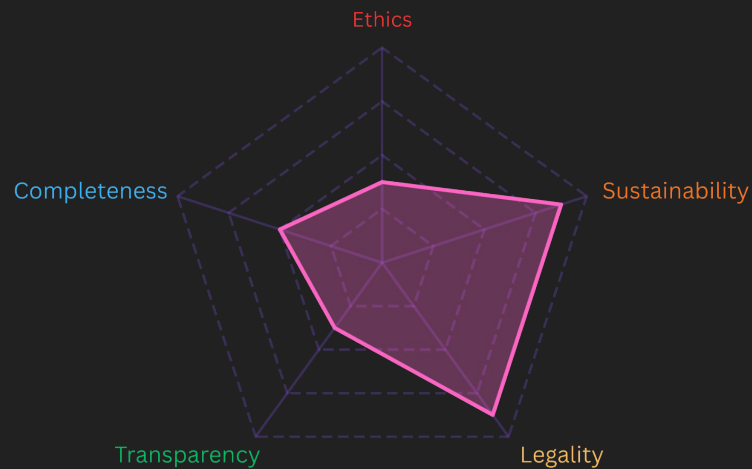
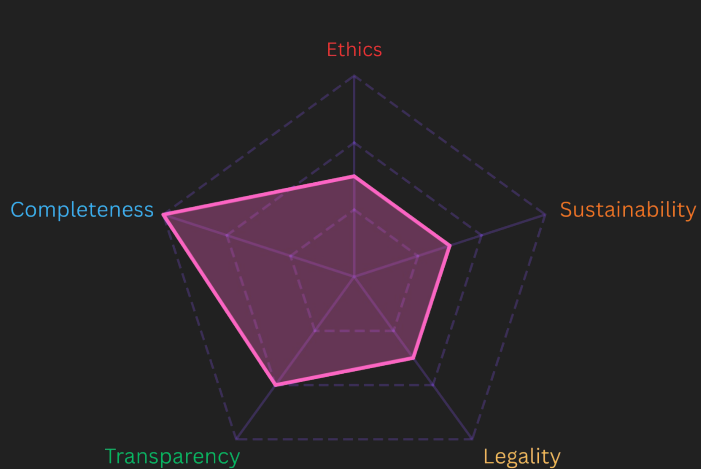
- Interactive
- Expandable
- Open Source



Five Values

Choice		A	B		
Scope	1	News Media	News + Social		
Method	2	Crawler + Black-Box	Human curation + data envelope		
Institutional linking - Community participation	3	Interlinking	Community participation		
Accessibility	4	Public	Restricted		
Score system	Ethics	Sustainability	Legality	Transparency	Completeness
Start	4	4	4	4	4
1A	0	2	2	0	-2
1B	0	-2	-2	0	2
2A	-1	1	0	-1	1
2B	1	-1	0	1	-1
3A	-1	1	0	0	1
3B	1	-1	0	1	1
4A	1	-1	-1	1	0
4B	-1	1	1	-1	0

There is no perfect archive



Testing at NIOD

Prompted Reflection

Think through
choices and
implications

Started Conversations

Starting points for
discussion

Revealed Limits

Cannot capture
every
consideration or
context

Three takeaways

01

SELECTION IS
UNAVOIDABLE

Every approach
shapes what
enters the
archive.

02

ACCESS REQUIRES
CONTEXTUAL
JUDGEMENT

Visibility and
openness can conflict
with the protection of
vulnerable people
and material.

03

PRIORITIES HAVE TO
BE NEGOTIATED

Archival decisions
involve competing
ethical, legal, practical,
and preservation
concerns.

Test it yourself

GitHub repository:

<https://github.com/jorannathoe/Case-Study-AIS-JLL-2026-Decision-Game>

Decision Simulator:

<https://jorannathoe.github.io/Case-Study-AIS-JLL-2026-Decision-Game/>

Thank you for listening!

Sources

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